

DPSH MUN 2026

IP

Empowering Voices, Uncovering the Truth!

INTERNATIONAL
PRESS

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THE STYLE GUIDE

Letter from the Executive Board

Dear members of the International Press,

We are delighted and deeply honoured to welcome you aboard the International Press of this Model United Nations edition. When you hear International Press, you may think of interviews, press conferences, newspapers, and more. However, journalism is a vast ocean, and in this Model United Nations simulation, you will take on the roles of journalists and photojournalists to experience it yourself.

As the executive board of the International Press, we want to remind you that we expect and accept all your little flaws in hopes that you learn something new from them and make your work close to perfection. Overcoming obstacles can only be achieved when one is willing to push oneself and not just think but work outside the box. At the same time, you should remember that diplomacy and transparency are the highest forms of respect, and all members of the International Press are expected to adhere to them.

To effectively tackle the challenges of this role, we highly recommend that members start their preliminary research well in advance to produce flawless work. Despite the competition, unlike other committees of the MUN, the International Press is a team. Our ultimate goal is to acquire resourceful articles and good-quality photos for an informative newsletter.

'Hesitation causes hindrance to perfection and shows the path to defeat', please do not hesitate to voice your queries, and feel free to reach out anytime. We hope you all have a wonderful experience, and we are looking forward to an engaging conference and working with all of you

Regards,

Venkata Kashvi Mandalapu

Head of Journalism

Shivika Saxena

Editor-in-Chief

About International Press

The International Press (IP) is neither a traditional committee of the United Nations nor an authentic part of any of the other UN committees. Here, the IP refers to the collection of international press agencies that gather from the corners of the world to report on the activities of the proceedings of various United Nations committees. As the delegates/diplomats, representing countries from all over the world gathered under a roof to engage in deliberation, the International Press records all the crucial moments in words as well as photographs. The International Press has always been an indispensable part of any Model UN and serves the most pertinent function of documentation of the deliberation.

While at the conference, you are required to keenly observe the goings-on, and take note of worthy instances, prepare reports, conduct research, formulate opinions, conduct interviews and polls, and preside a press conference for the Delegates. A good news article ought to be articulate and brief and be able to convey the very essence of any discussion

There are three things which come as a part and parcel of any International Press Team at a Model UN Conference simulation.

1. **Research:** Comprehensive research forms the basic framework of the art of reporting. A journalist in a committee needs to be well informed, rather better equipped with their research since it is not going to be country-specific. Half-baked knowledge on the agendas reflects factual inconsistency in the articles. Kindly go through the background guides of your respective committees to have a better understanding of the agenda. Knowledge of current debates about the agenda is also encouraged.
2. **Unity:** The International Press team will consist of several reporters, who need to be working in synchronization with each other. The spirit of competitiveness should never come in the way of teamwork, and all the efforts should be to publish a prosperous newsletter.
3. **Code of Conduct:** Reporters are expected to maintain diplomatic courtesy at all times towards fellow members of the team, delegates, executive board and the Secretariat. Even while critically looking at council proceedings; it is imperative that respect be extended to the delegates. Frivolous reporting, like reporting on a delegate's attire or manner of speaking, is highly discouraged.

Types of Submissions

Opinionated Editorial

An Opinionated editorial (Op-Ed) is an article that appears opposite the editorial page of practically all newspapers. This is a place where the writer gets an opportunity to pen down on the agenda **his/her perspective** or a snippet of the debate. **Research is absolutely vital, and every opinion must be firmly backed by relevant facts.**

Word Limit - *500 to 600 words*

Beat

A Beat-based article is a specialised article where the Reporter presents an **in-depth coverage** of a particular issue, situation, institution, or the like. **It involves the amassing of more knowledge than a traditional news report.** The beat is a central idea around which the contents of the article revolve. Ideally, it is the core concern or subject and should pertain to every single line used in the formation of the article. Requiring clear observations and grasping power, Beats should be **devoid** of the reporter's **opinion.**

Word Limit - *250 to 300 words*

Creative Piece / Feature

This is the only submission where the reporters are allowed to explore **any format of their own.** It just has to **adhere to the agenda of the respective committee.** A major contributor to your freestyle working autonomy will be the submission of a creative piece, which can be a diary entry or a short story, as long as the **content is original** and absolutely your own artwork. This gives you the ability to play with words and ideas, albeit in keeping with the agenda, as your piece should revolve around a central theme that is drawn off the agenda, in whole or part.

Word Limit - *150 to 800 words*

Interview

An interview provides an opportunity for a **personal interaction** with a delegate/EB member. It should be utilised to **bring out those aspects which might not otherwise be highlighted in the course of the conference.** The questions must be precise and **must be verified** by the Executive Board of the International Press. Reporters may paraphrase the answers, but are expected to

ensure that the essence of the views put forth remains intact.

Word Limit – *350 to 500 words*

Consolidated Report

A piece written in account of the same. Ideally to be written in paragraphs, this piece provides the reader with an overview of the happenings of the committee during the duration of the conference.

This submission focuses on how the entire committee's proceedings went and gives a reported speech exclusively concise.

Word Limit – *300 to 350 words*

Opinion Poll

This particular type of article allows you to express the **delegates' opinion** of a specific subtopic in any manner you want. Again, the content needs to be restricted to the agenda. **The use of graphs, pie-charts or any other statistical analysis of the data collected is highly encouraged.**

Word Limit – *250 to 350 words*

Press Conference

The Press Conference is another opportunity for the reporters to ask the representatives about any of their statements or policies in the committee. Reporters must establish dialogue with the representatives and are required to **adhere to diplomatic courtesy**. Decorum and composure regardless of the situation must be maintained. Moreover, **facts must be derived from credible sources**; if challenged, the burden of proof rests on the reporter.

Always remember the **representatives are not obligated to provide answers** during the press conference, reporters may choose to move on or, if they deem the answer necessary, may rearticulate their choice of words to get the response.

Submission Deadlines

All reporters are required to strictly adhere to the assigned deadlines, which will be discussed in advance to allow ample time for article writing.

Rules and Regulations

An important aspect of writing an article is adhering to proper formatting procedure. The format expected from articles is as follows:

TITLE

Font: Times new roman

Point size: 16 Alignment:

Centre

“BOLD IN CAPITALS”

BY LINE

Font: Times new roman

Point size: 13

Alignment: Centre

“Italicised”

BODY

Font: Times new roman

Point size: 12

Alignment: Justified

“Normal text”

Language expected to be used is British English.

1. The information used in your articles must be from reliable sources. Sources from tabloids, Wikipedia, etc. will not be permitted. Always cite your sources at the end of your article, or using the citation feature.
2. Plagiarism is strictly not allowed. The use of AI, GPT platforms, or plagiarizing other articles is not permitted. Any articles that are shown to be using AI will not be marked.
3. Avoid inappropriate language in your articles. Do not make personal comments on the delegates.
4. Use neutral terms. For instance, instead of saying mankind use the word humankind instead.
5. Numbers from one to ten should be written in words, while numbers above so can be written numerically. Eg: (three, 50, 75 million)
6. Be careful not to confuse statements made by the delegate with the portfolio as a whole. If you are referring to a statement made by the delegate, say “ The Delegate of India said...” rather than “India said...”

7. Keep your language formal and respectful. Do not use contractions- instead of 'don't', say 'do not'.
8. Introduce any abbreviations before using them further.
Eg: The United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland (UK)
9. Strictly adhere to submission deadlines for your Articles. Lack of punctuality will affect marking accordingly.
10. When submitting articles, ensure they are saved in the following format
"Name_Committee_Type of Article_Day" Eg:
V.Kashvi.M_UNHRC_Feature_DayOne
11. The format of your by line should be as follows - "**Name** reporting from **committee reports/opines/depicts upon/etc./ on topic**". You are free to use your creativity here.
12. Refrain from using words that are used during committee procedure, such as 'moderated caucus', 'general speaker's list', etc. instead use 'formal debate' and 'informal debate'.
13. International Press members will be allowed to submit via paper, but must discuss with the executive board prior to the conference.
14. Reporters are expected to be professional and diplomatic at all times.
15. Unless told otherwise, reporters should remain in the committee at all times the session is on.
16. Journalists should carry their own devices for writing and submission of articles during the MUN proceedings.
17. All electronic devices must be kept on silent during committee sessions so as to not disturb committee proceedings.

